

1 ENGROSSED SENATE  
2 BILL NO. 1272

By: Hines and Goodwin of the  
Senate

3 and

4 Hasenbeck of the House

5  
6 An Act relating to higher education; amending 70 O.S.  
7 2021, Section 2632, as amended by Section 1, Chapter  
8 129, O.S.L. 2025 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 2632),  
9 which relates to eligibility for an Oklahoma Tuition  
10 Equalization Grant; increasing income eligibility;  
11 updating statutory language; updating statutory  
12 references; providing an effective date; and  
13 declaring an emergency.

14 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

15 SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 2632, as  
16 amended by Section 1, Chapter 129, O.S.L. 2025 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025,  
17 Section 2632), is amended to read as follows:

18 Section 2632. A. To be eligible for an Oklahoma Tuition  
19 Equalization Grant, a student shall:

20 1. Be ~~an Oklahoma~~ a resident of this state as defined by the  
21 Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education;

22 2. Have enrolled as a full-time undergraduate student in an  
23 eligible institution of higher education as prescribed in subsection  
24 D of this section;

25 3. Meet the income eligibility level, which is the student's  
26 parents' income from taxable sources which shall not be more than

1 ~~Fifty Thousand Dollars (\$50,000.00)~~ Eighty Thousand Dollars  
2 (\$80,000.00) per year or the student's income if the student is  
3 independent and self-supporting as determined by the State Regents  
4 consistent with federal financial aid regulations;

5 4. Pay more tuition than is required at a comparable public  
6 institution of higher education and pay no less than the regular  
7 tuition required of all students enrolled at the institution ~~where~~  
8 in which the student is enrolled; and

9 5. Maintain at least minimum standards of academic performance  
10 as required by the enrolling institution.

11 B. The enrolling institution shall forward a completed student  
12 application, documentation of full-time enrollment status, and  
13 certification of resident status to the State Regents no later than  
14 October 15 for the fall semester and March 15 for the spring  
15 semester of each academic year.

16 C. Subject to the availability of funds in the Oklahoma Tuition  
17 Equalization Grant Trust Fund, an Oklahoma Tuition Equalization  
18 Grant in the amount of Two Thousand Dollars (\$2,000.00) per academic  
19 year, or One Thousand Dollars (\$1,000.00) per academic semester  
20 shall be awarded by the State Regents by allocation from the  
21 Oklahoma Tuition Equalization Grant Trust Fund, beginning with  
22 eligible students enrolled in the 2003-2004 school year. No grants  
23 pursuant to ~~this act~~ the Oklahoma Tuition Equalization Grant Act  
24

1 shall be provided to students for attending summer terms or  
2 intersessions.

3 D. The State Regents shall implement policies and procedures  
4 for the administration of ~~this act~~ the Oklahoma Tuition Equalization  
5 Grant Act. The State Regents shall approve as eligible institutions  
6 of higher education only those private or independent, not-for-  
7 profit colleges or universities that are domiciled within this  
8 state, meet approved program and accreditation standards as  
9 determined by the State Regents, and are fully accredited by the  
10 Higher Learning Commission ~~of the North Central Association on~~  
11 ~~Colleges and Schools~~ or a national accrediting body recognized by  
12 the United States Department of Education. To be eligible,  
13 institutions ~~must~~ shall have ~~been granted~~ not-for-profit status  
14 granted by the Internal Revenue Service and the ~~U. S.~~ United States  
15 Department of Education prior to July 1, 2012. Additionally,  
16 eligible institutions shall adhere to the complaint process policies  
17 and procedures administered by the State Regents. The State Regents  
18 shall review and take action, as authorized, on complaints  
19 concerning eligible institutions. The eligible institutions shall  
20 include Family of Faith College, Mid-America Christian University,  
21 Oklahoma Baptist University, Oklahoma Christian University, Oklahoma  
22 City University, Oklahoma Wesleyan University, Oral Roberts  
23 University, Southern Nazarene University, Southwestern Christian  
24 University, the University of Tulsa, and Randall University.

1 E. If funds are not sufficient in the Oklahoma Tuition  
2 Equalization Grant Trust Fund to provide grants for all eligible  
3 applicants, the State Regents shall award grants on the basis of  
4 need and take into consideration other grants and scholarships  
5 received by an eligible applicant when awarding grants. Students  
6 who have previously received a tuition equalization grant and who  
7 continue to meet the requirements for eligibility shall have  
8 absolute priority for continued financial support superior to any  
9 student who is applying for a grant for the first time.

10 F. Students enrolling as first-time freshmen for the 2003-2004  
11 school year shall be the first class of students eligible to apply  
12 for Oklahoma Tuition Equalization Grants. In subsequent years, all  
13 previously eligible students and the first-time enrolling freshmen  
14 students shall be entitled to apply for a grant pursuant to this  
15 section. Beginning in the 2007-2008 school year, all eligible  
16 students shall be entitled to apply for a grant pursuant to this  
17 section.

18 G. A grant provided ~~by~~ pursuant to this section shall not be  
19 allowed for courses or other postsecondary units taken in excess of  
20 the requirements for completion of a baccalaureate program or taken  
21 more than five (5) years after the student's first grant ~~is~~ was  
22 received. The State Regents may award an Oklahoma Tuition  
23 Equalization Grant for courses of postsecondary units taken more  
24 than five (5) years after the student's first grant ~~is~~ was received

1 only in hardship circumstances. No Oklahoma Tuition Equalization  
2 Grant recipient may receive benefits beyond a cumulative time period  
3 of five (5) years.

4 H. On or before February 1 after the first semester in which  
5 grants are awarded pursuant to ~~this act~~ the Oklahoma Tuition  
6 Equalization Grant Act and every year thereafter, the State Regents  
7 shall provide a report to the Governor, President Pro Tempore of the  
8 Senate, and ~~the~~ Speaker of the House of Representatives to include,  
9 but not be limited, to the number of students awarded grants, and  
10 the grade point average, persistence rates, degree completion rates,  
11 demographic data, and any other indicators for such students the  
12 State Regents deem appropriate.

13 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

14 SECTION 3. It being immediately necessary for the preservation  
15 of the public peace, health, or safety, an emergency is hereby  
16 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and  
17 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

1 Passed the Senate the 24th day of March, 2026.

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3 \_\_\_\_\_  
4 Presiding Officer of the Senate

5 Passed the House of Representatives the \_\_\_\_ day of \_\_\_\_\_,  
6 2026.

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8 \_\_\_\_\_  
9 Presiding Officer of the House  
10 of Representatives